

ALI ISSE

Ph.D. Candidate, Security Studies & International Relations

School of Public and International Affairs · Robertson Hall · Princeton University · Princeton, NJ 08540

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Nuclear Proliferation & Nonproliferation · Coercive Diplomacy · War & the Use of Force · Alliance Politics
& Extended Deterrence · U.S. Foreign Policy

EDUCATION

2027 Princeton University

Ph.D., Public & International Affairs — *Security Studies & International Relations*

M.A., Public Affairs (2024)

Dissertation committee: Christopher Chyba (chair); G. John Ikenberry; Kristopher Ramsay

Dissertation: "The Politics of Nuclear Prevention: Strategic Choices in Proliferation Crises"

2021 The University of Chicago

M.A., Social Science — *Political Science & International Relations*

Thesis advisor: Roger B. Myerson

2018 The Ohio State University

M.S., City & Regional Planning; Minor in Public Policy & Management

2015 The University of Texas at San Antonio

B.A., Political Science; Minor in Global Affairs

PUBLICATIONS & WORKS IN PROGRESS

2026 **Isse, A.** U.S.–U.K. Nuclear Partnership: Cooperation, Integration, and Strategic Interdependence.

Target Journal: *Journal of Strategic Studies*. In preparation

Isse, A. Authoritarian Calculus and the Risk of Nuclear Use: Executive Power and Brinkmanship in North Korea and Iran. *Target journal:* *Journal of Conflict Resolution*. In progress

2024 **Isse, A.** Between Coercion and Inducements: Ensuring Compliance in Nuclear Disarmament Under the NPT and TPNW. *Under Review*.

Isse, A. The Strategies of Coercion in the Nuclear Era: From Diplomacy to War. *Forthcoming*.

2021 **Isse, A.** Statebuilding in Somalia: The Role of International Actors and Actions.

Knowledge Uchicago.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2022–2027 **Doctoral Researcher** — Nuclear Proliferation, Coercive Diplomacy, and the Use of Force.
School of Public & International Affairs, Princeton University.
- 2025–2026 **Resident Fellow, Nuclear Security Program** — Dissertation research. MacMillan Center,
Department of Political Science, Yale University
- Sum–2025 **Archival Fieldwork:** — Primary sources on counter-proliferation & US-UK nuclear security
cooperation. British National Archives (Kew), LSE Library Archives, Churchill Archives Center
- 2020–2021 **Graduate Researcher**, Division of the Social Sciences, Department of Political Science, The
University of Chicago

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- 2025 **Preceptor (TA), POL 396: International Organizations** (Undergraduate)
Department of Politics, Princeton University – Spring 2025 – three weekly sessions, office hours,
grading exams, evaluating class participation, and assignments
- 2024 **Preceptor (TA), SPI 299: Introduction to Research Design** (Undergraduate)
School of Public & International Affairs, Princeton University – Fall 2024 – three weekly sessions,
office hours, grading exams and final papers

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

- 2025 **Resident Fellow, Nuclear Security Program**, MacMillan Center for International and Area
Studies at Yale [AY 2025–2026]
- 2025 **IvyPlus Exchange Scholar Fellow**, Department of Political Science, Yale (AY 2025–2026)
- 2025 **Pre-Dissertation Fieldwork & Research Grant**, Princeton Institute for International and Re-
gional Studies (PIIRS)– Summer 2025, UK
- 2025 **Summer Fieldwork Travel Grant**, Princeton School of Public & International Affairs
- 2023 **Africa Program Fellow**, Liechtenstein Institute on Self-Determination (LISD), Princeton SPIA
(2023–2025)
- 2022 **Center for International Security Studies (CISS) Graduate Fellow**, Princeton University
(2022–2025)
- 2022 **President’s Fellowship Award**, Princeton University (2022–2024)
- 2021 **Maroon Scholar Research Award**, The University of Chicago (2020–2021)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2025 **Alva Myrdal Center for Nuclear Disarmament, Uppsala Universitet, Sverige.**

Oral presentation of "Between Coercion and Inducements: Ensuring Compliance in Nuclear Disarmament Under the NPT and TPNW", 2025 Cross-Disciplinary Conference at Uppsala University, Sweden.

82nd Annual MPSA Conference 2025: Lightning Talk Paper Presentation

A Isse, R Omar. Regime Type, Antimigrant Sentiments and Support for State Surveillance in the Public Space. *Lightning talk Paper Presentation.* Chicago, IL. April 2025.

2024 **Bridging The Gap—NEW Era Foreign Policy Conference**

Panelist, roundtable discussions on connecting academic research to practical policymaking. Josef Korbel School of International Studies, University of Denver. September 2024.

2021 **2021 Interdisciplinary Graduate Conference.** *Oral presentation—Spotlight Paper, at The University of Chicago, April 2021*

INVITED TALKS & RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS

2025 **International Relations Seminar, MacMillan Center of International and Area Studies**
Department of Political Science, Yale University.

Presented doctoral prospectus on nuclear deterrence, coercive diplomacy, and strategic stability.
October, 2025

2024 **Africa Policy Program,** Liechtenstein Institute of Self-Determination (LISD) at Princeton
Presented research paper, "International Intervention and Regional Dynamics in Africa".
October 2024.

Security Studies Seminar, Center for International Security Studies (CISS) at Princeton.

Presented research on nuclear deterrence, coercive diplomacy, and strategic dynamics within security studies. February 2024.

2023 **Diversity and Inclusion Speaker Series,** Princeton SPIA. *Delivered invited talk, "Coming to America: Challenges and Opportunities.* March, 2023.

ACADEMIC/ PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2025 Discussant — Alva Myrdal Conference, Uppsala University, Sweden

2025 Discussant — International Security Section, MPSA Annual Conference

2024 Participant & Mentor—International Policy Trip to Ghana, Princeton University (Winter 2024)

2023 Peer Mentor—Graduate Scholars Program (GSP), Princeton University (AY 2023–2025)

2023 Member—CISS Policy Speakers Series Planning Team, Princeton University (AY 2023–2024)

2022 Member—CISS Colloquium Planning Team, Princeton University (AY 2022–2023)

2021 Panelist — International Relations Section, Graduate Interdisciplinary Conference, UChicago

2020 Undergraduate Mentor—Office of Multicultural Student Affairs, UChicago (AY 2020–2021)

2018 Member—Accreditation & Assessment Committee, Dept. of City & Regional Planning
The Ohio State University

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2021–2022 **Grants Specialist** — Catholic Charities of the Diocese of Saint Cloud, Minnesota (2021–2022)
Developed and managed competitive grant proposals and built partnership with foundations and governmental agencies at state and federal levels.

2018–2020 **Assistant Planner** — Conducted research, data and spatial analysis, and GIS mapping in support of land-use, transportation, and community development planning

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association (APSA) · International Studies Association (ISA) · Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Technical Skills: R · Stata · Python · SPSS · L^AT_EX · ArcGIS

Languages: Somali (native) · English (fluent) · Arabic (fluent)

SPECIALIZED TRAINING

Sum 2023 **University of Cambridge** — International Summer Programme Cambridge, UK
Coursework: 1. *The Use of Force: The Legality of War as a Tool of Policy Before/After UN Charter*
2. *Civilizing War? Human Rights and the Contemporary Law of Armed Conflict*

Spr. 2018 **National Taipei University** Taipei, Taiwan
Coursework: *Infrastructure, Mobility, and Military Logistics in East Asia*